

cardlio

User Handbook

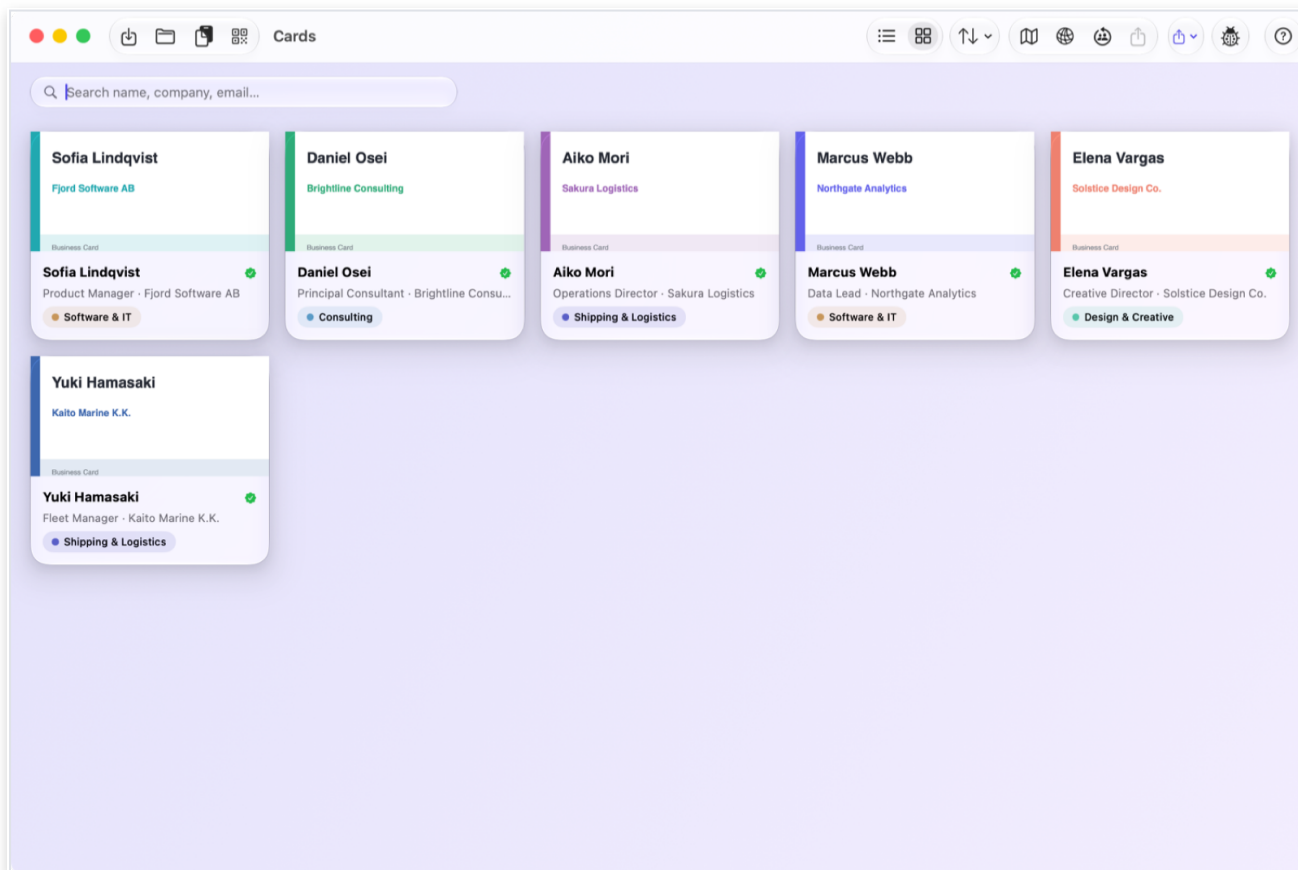
cardlio turns business cards into clean, structured contacts — entirely on your device. Scan with the camera, import photos, or paste an email signature; review the result; then export to Contacts, a spreadsheet, or your CRM. This handbook walks through every feature on **iPhone, iPad, and Mac**.

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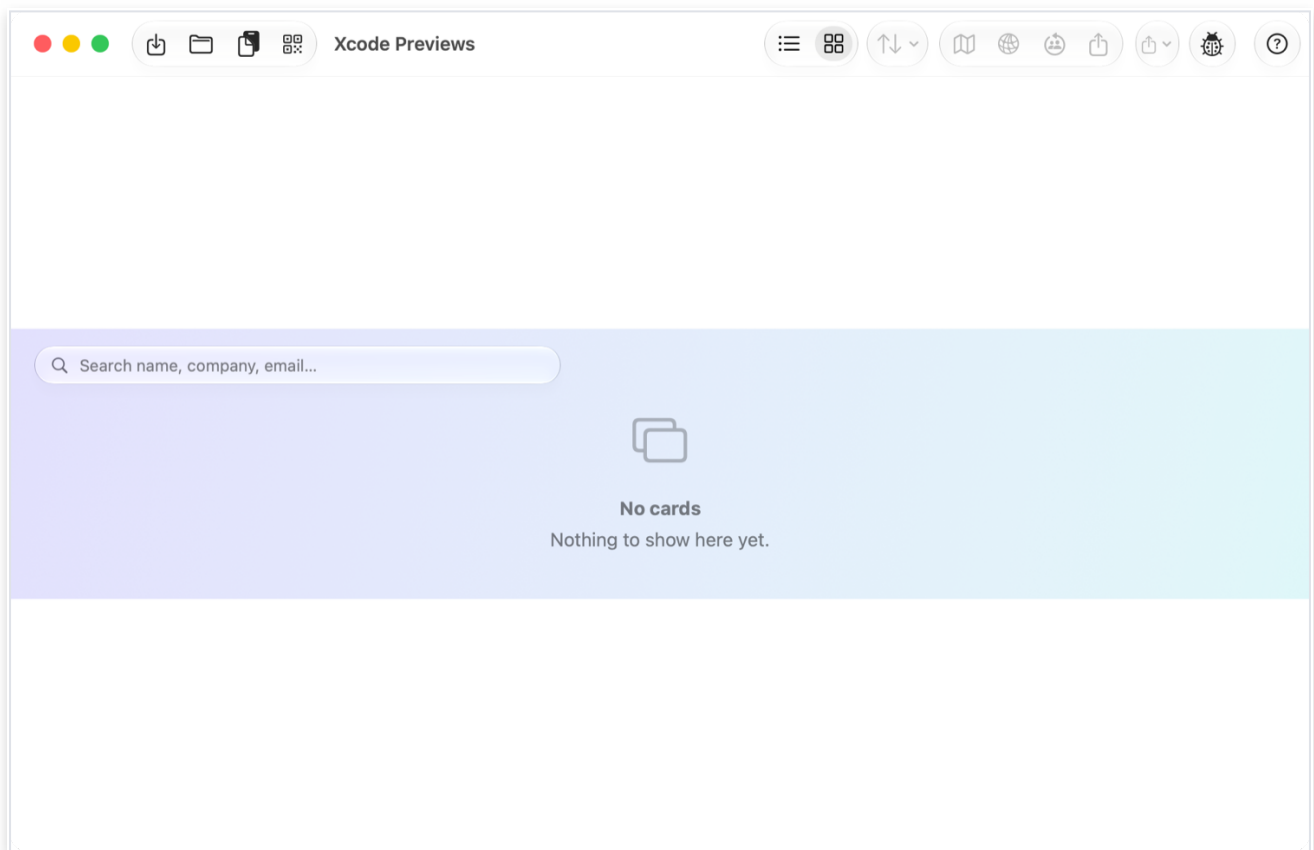
The main window & toolbar

The main window is your card library. On **Mac** it's a resizable window with a list or gallery view; on **iPhone and iPad** it's a scrollable list. Search by name, company, city, or email at any time — and as you type, cardlio suggests **filter tokens** for countries, companies, and industries, so "Japan" can mean *cards from Japan* rather than cards containing the word.



The Mac library in gallery view. Each tile shows the person, company, and card image.

The toolbar gathers every action. Related buttons are grouped into segments; the **Help** button sits on its own at the trailing edge so it's always easy to find.



The Mac toolbar. Left to right: add / import, paste signature & My Card, view & sort, the Map · Stats · Duplicates group, Share, Export, developer tools — and the separated Help (?) button.

- **Add Files / Import** — bring in card photos or PDFs.
- **Map · Stats · Duplicates** — visualize, analyze, and clean up your library.
- **Share / Export** — send a single card or export the whole library.
- **Help (?)** — opens the in-app handbook (a shorter version of this document).

Getting started — capturing a card

There are several ways to bring a card into cardlio. All recognition happens on-device, so you can scan anywhere, online or off.

Camera & AR scanner (iPhone / iPad)

Point the camera at a card. The live view detects the card edges and captures automatically; in the AR scanner you tap the shutter to grab the current frame. Rotated or skewed cards are straightened for you.



Live camera capture

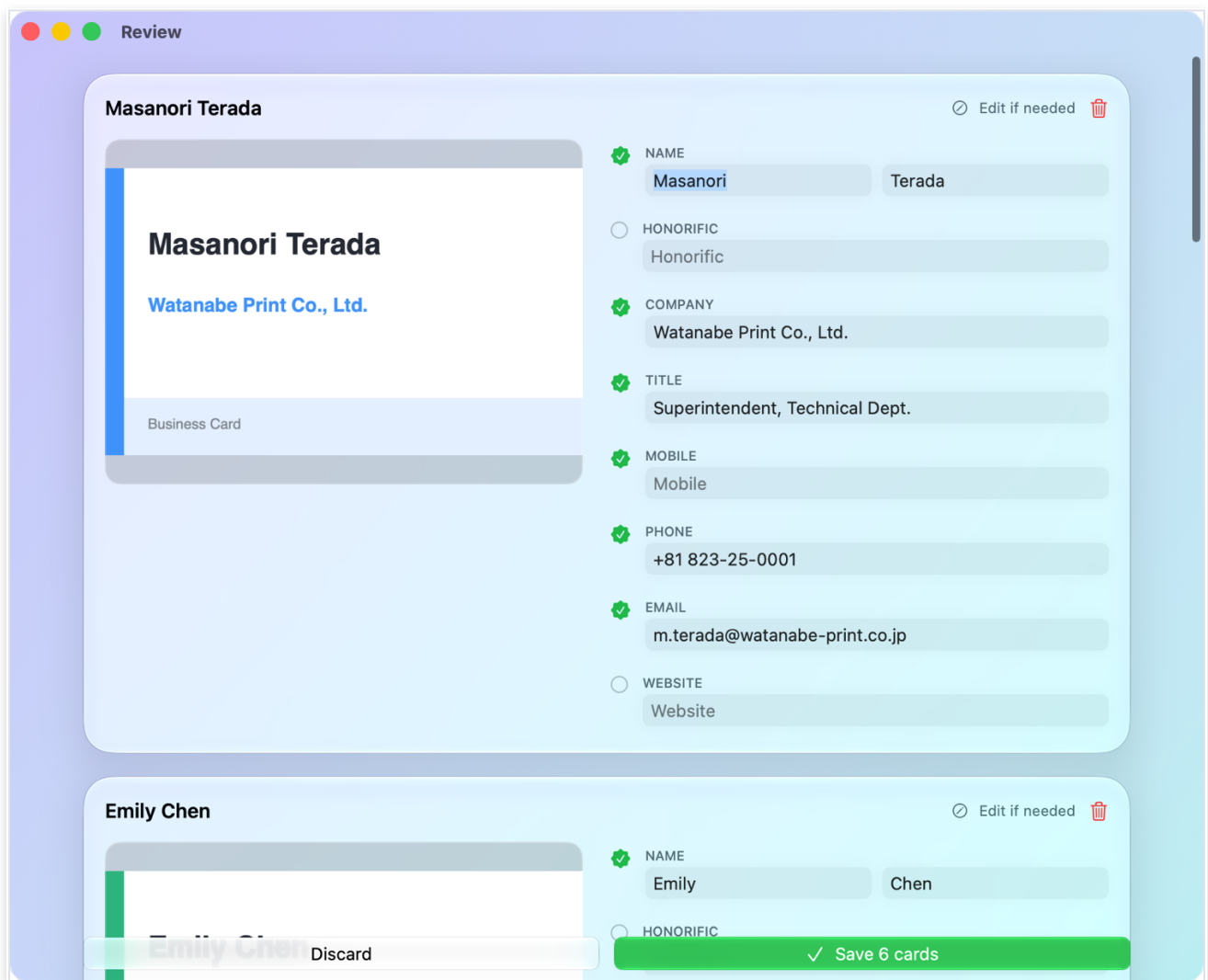
Screenshot unavailable — the live camera and AR scanner can only be captured on a physical device.

Photos, Share sheet & Paste

- **Photos** — import one or more card images from your library.
- **Share sheet** — share a card image (or a copied email signature) from any app straight into cardlio.
- **Paste a signature** — paste the text of an email signature and cardlio builds a card from it, no photo needed.

Reviewing & editing a scan

After a scan, cardlio shows a review screen before anything is saved. Each field carries a validity badge, and anything the parser was unsure about is easy to correct. You can drop a stray detection without discarding the rest of the batch.



The review screen. Green badges mark validated fields; every field is editable, and the button saves the whole batch at once.

- Tap any field to edit it.
- A green check means the value looks valid (e.g. a well-formed email or phone).
- Use the trash icon on a card to remove just that one from the batch.

How recognition works

Recognition combines the card's **text** with its **visual layout** — the largest text near the top is treated as the name, keyword and language cues separate title from company, and the on-device text engine pre-detects emails, phones, and addresses. That layered approach handles many awkward real-world cards:

Topic Detail

Recognition is on-device and uses both the text and the card's visual layout, so it handles many awkward real-world cards:

- **ALL-CAPS names** (e.g. "MASANORI TERADA") are recognized as the person, not the company, and shown title-cased.
- **Department titles** like "Superintendent, Technical Dept." are captured as the job title.
- **Japanese addresses** in romaji (e.g. "Kure Hiroshima") resolve the city and prefecture.
- **Spaced-out emails** (e.g. "s. tanaka @ eifukukaiun. co. jp") are repaired into a valid address.
- **Multi-office cards** keep the primary office; the rest go to Notes.

If something is still off, just edit the field — corrections are quick and the card saves immediately.

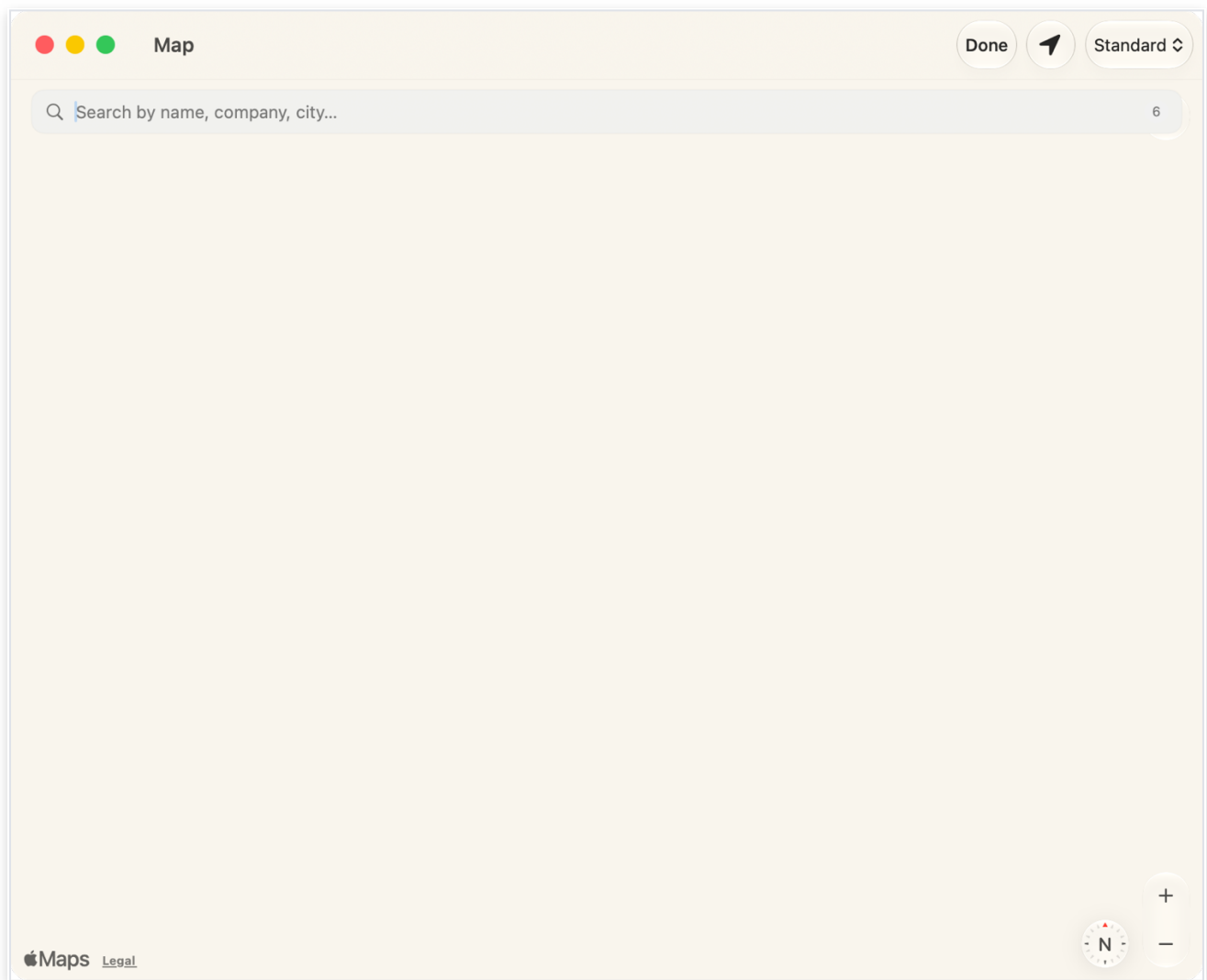
The in-app explanation of the recognition edge cases cardlio handles automatically.

- **ALL-CAPS names** are recognized as the person, not the company, and shown title-cased.
- **Department titles** like "Superintendent, Technical Dept." are captured as the job title.
- **Japanese addresses** in romaji resolve the city and prefecture.
- **Spaced-out emails** ("s. tanaka @ example. co. jp") are repaired into a valid address.
- **Multi-office cards** keep the primary office in the address fields and preserve the rest in Notes.

If anything is still off, just edit the field — corrections are quick and the card saves immediately.

Addresses & the map

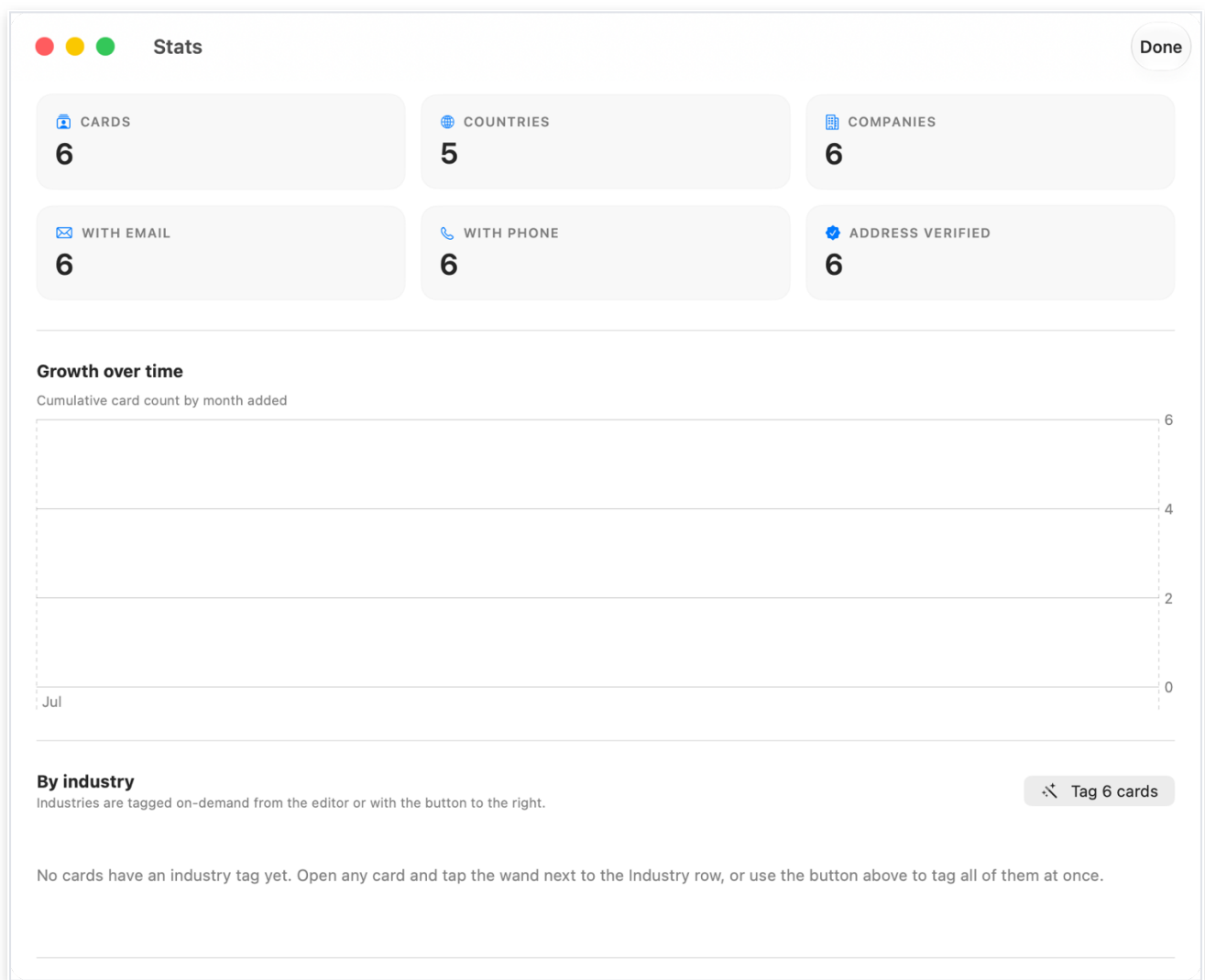
Every address is checked against **Apple Maps** to normalize the city, postal code, and country, and to drop a pin. Verification runs automatically on scans, imports, pasted signatures, and shared cards — no third-party service, and nothing leaves Apple's ecosystem.



The Map screen. Search across your contacts and see them alongside your location. (Map tiles and pins require a network connection; this render was captured offline.)

Network stats

The Stats screen summarizes your library at a glance: how many cards you have, how many countries and companies they span, and how completely they're filled in. A growth chart tracks cards added over time, and you can tag cards by industry.



The Stats screen with a sample library of six cards across five countries.

AI refinement

On top of the built-in parser, cardlio can optionally use AI to decide which line is the person versus the company on especially tricky cards. This is always optional — the deterministic parser handles everything on its own.

- **On-device (Apple Intelligence)** — private, offline, no key required. Available on supported devices.
- **Cloud (bring your own key)** — Anthropic Claude or Google Gemini for the hardest cards. Add a key under Cloud Settings.

Cloud AI is opt-in. Your API key is stored in the Keychain and is only ever sent to the provider you choose. With no key and no Apple Intelligence, nothing is sent anywhere.

Exports — Contacts, CSV & Salesforce

Export a single card or your entire library. On Mac, use the Export menu in the toolbar; on iPhone and iPad, the Export button opens the share sheet.

- **vCard (.vcf)** — imports into Apple Contacts, Outlook, Google Contacts, and both iPhone and Android.
- **Generic CSV** — every field, for spreadsheets.
- **Outlook CSV** — the column names Outlook's import expects.
- **Salesforce CSV** — headers that auto-map in Salesforce's Data Import Wizard; records import as **Leads**.

All CSV exports are hardened against spreadsheet formula injection, so a value that begins with =, +, or @ can't execute when the file is opened.

iCloud sync

Cards sync across your devices through your **private iCloud database** — only you can see them. Sign into the same Apple ID on each device and new scans and edits propagate automatically in the background. There is no server that we operate; sync is entirely Apple's CloudKit.

Sharing your card — link, QR, NFC & Wallet

Create **My Card** with your own details and hand it out any way the moment calls for. Nothing is required on the other end — no app, no account.

My Card

Done



Scan to add me to contacts



Alex Rivera

Product Lead · Solstice Design Co.

Standard vCard 3.0 — any phone's built-in QR scanner adds this card as a contact. No app required on the other end.



Add to Apple Wallet



SHARING



Share Link

with photo



QR shows

vCard · Web link



Write NFC Tag

NTAG216

My Card: scan the QR, tap the NFC tag, or add the card to Apple Wallet.

- **Share Link** — sends a cardlio.app link (including your photo) through Messages, Mail, or AirDrop. Opening it shows your card in the browser with an Add to Contacts button. Your details are encoded inside the link itself — in the part of the address that browsers never send to any server — so nobody but the recipient ever sees them.
- **QR code** — the on-screen QR can show a standard vCard 3.0 (any phone's camera adds you directly, fully offline) or the compact web link — switch with the toggle.
- **NFC tag** — write your card link to an **NTAG216** tag. A tap on an iPhone (XS or newer) or Android phone opens your card, straight from the lock screen. Smaller tags usually don't have enough memory; the app tells you when a tag is too small.
- **Apple Wallet** — one tap on **Add to Apple Wallet** puts your card in Wallet on iPhone, with the QR on the front — no setup or certificates needed. Creating the pass needs a connection; afterwards it works offline forever. On the Mac, cardlio builds the pass file so you can AirDrop it to your iPhone.

NFC tags and QR codes carry a compact card without the photo — tags are tiny. Links from the Share Link button include it.

Voice notes

Record a short voice note after a scan — "met at the expo, follow up on pricing" — and cardlio transcribes it into the card's Notes, cleaned into concise bullet points when Apple Intelligence is available.

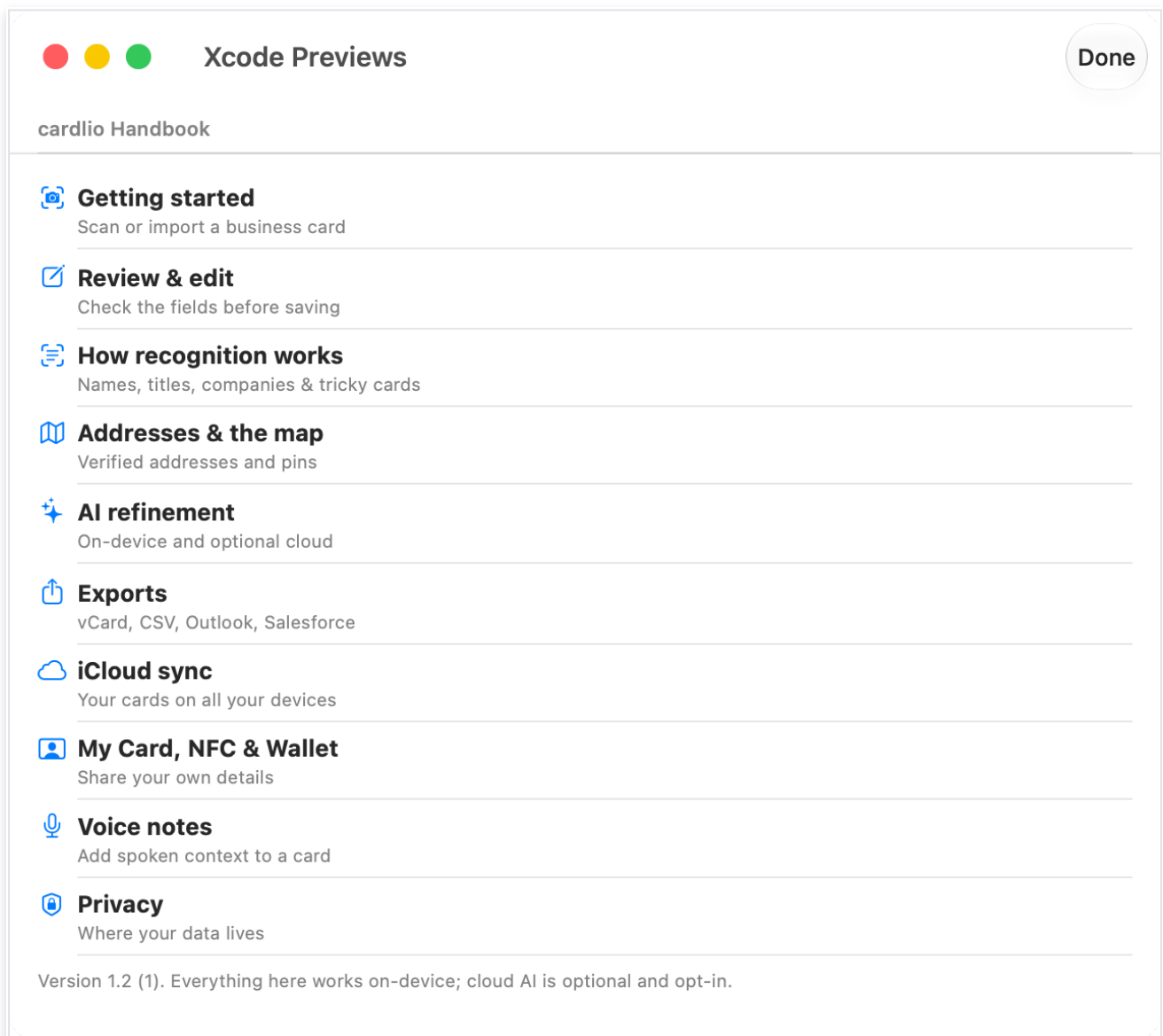


Voice note recorder

Screenshot unavailable — the recorder is a live-audio flow best captured on a device.

The in-app handbook

A shorter version of this guide is built into the app. Open it any time from the Help (?) button on Mac, or the Handbook item in the menu on iPhone and iPad. It works offline and always matches the version you're running.



The in-app handbook — the same topics, one tap away inside cardlio.

Privacy & your data

cardlio is built to keep your contacts yours:

- OCR, parsing, and on-device AI all run **locally** on your device.
- Sync uses **your private iCloud** — there is no server we operate.
- Cloud AI and address lookup are opt-in; cloud AI only runs if you add your own key.
- API keys live in the **Keychain** and never sync off your device unless you enable iCloud Keychain.
- Shared card links carry your card **inside the link itself** — no server ever receives it. Creating a Wallet pass sends your card once to the signing service, which stores and logs nothing.

Tips & troubleshooting

- **Sharpest scans:** fill the frame with the card, keep it flat and well-lit, and avoid glare.
- **A field looks wrong?** Tap to edit — the fix saves immediately and future scans aren't affected.
- **Map is blank?** Pins and tiles need a network connection; addresses still verify and store their coordinates.
- **Card not syncing?** Confirm the same Apple ID and that iCloud Drive is enabled on each device.
- **Duplicates piling up?** Open the Duplicates tool to review and merge matches.